

At the elbow

The movement of your elbow (the joint where your arm bones meet) is controlled by a pair of muscles called the biceps and triceps.

Quick quiz

- ★ Where are your biceps and triceps?
- ★ What is your biggest muscle called?
- ★ How many muscles are in your body?

① Bending

When your biceps muscle contracts (gets shorter and thicker), it bends your elbow and pulls your lower arm toward your shoulder.

Biceps

Triceps

Why do I have muscles?

Muscles are important because they help your body to move. Without them you would not be able to walk, jump, blink, or breathe. Muscles are made of bundles of fibers, each one as thin as a hair.